Example Pineywoods Regional Medical Center

Charity Care and Discount Policy

Revision date: March 15, 2026 (supersedes the policy dated July 1, 2023)

1. Purpose

Example Pineywoods Regional Medical Center is committed to providing financial assistance to patients who are uninsured, underinsured, or otherwise unable to pay for emergency and other medically necessary care, consistent with Section 501(r) of the Internal Revenue Code and applicable Texas law.

2. Scope

This Policy applies to emergency and other medically necessary care provided by Example Pineywoods Regional Medical Center.

This Policy does not cover physician professional fees billed separately.

A list of providers who deliver care in the Hospital, showing which providers are and are not covered by this Policy, is in the Provider List posted at https://www.examplepineywoods.example/billing/providers.

3. Definitions

3.1 Household. For purposes of this Policy, the household includes the patient and any person the patient is legally responsible for supporting.

3.2 Income. Household income means the household's total gross annual income before taxes and deductions.

3.3 Federal Poverty Guidelines (FPG). Eligibility is determined using the Federal Poverty Guidelines in effect on the date the application is received.

3.4 Medically necessary care. Care that is reasonable and necessary to diagnose or treat an illness or injury, as determined by the treating provider.

4. Eligibility for Financial Assistance

4.1 Patients may qualify for financial assistance if household income is at or below 250% of the FPG and the other conditions of this Policy are met.

Patients with household income at or below 150% of the Federal Poverty Guidelines qualify for free care, a 100% discount.

Patients with household income above 150% and at or below 250% of the Federal Poverty Guidelines receive a 60% discount from gross charges.

5. Other Eligibility Conditions

5.1 Assets. The Hospital does not consider assets when determining eligibility.

5.2 Residency. To qualify, patients must reside in one of the following Texas counties: Angelina, Nacogdoches, Polk, Trinity, or Houston. The residency requirement does not apply to emergency care.

5.3 Insurance. Financial assistance under this Policy is available only to patients who have no health insurance.

5.4 Other programs. Patients who appear likely to qualify for Medicaid must apply for Medicaid before financial assistance is approved.

6. How to Apply

6.1 Application period. Patients may apply at any time within 240 days after the date of the first post-discharge billing statement.

6.2 Required documents. Applicants must attach the following documents:

(a) W-2 forms for the most recent tax year;

(b) four weeks of pay stubs;

(c) photo identification;

6.3 Where to apply. Completed applications may be submitted:

- By mail to Business Office, 1500 Example Timberland Drive, Lufkin, TX 75904.

- By fax to (936) 555-0499.

6.4 Determination. The Hospital will notify the patient in writing of its determination and the basis for the determination.

6.5 Award period. Approved financial assistance applies to eligible care for 6 months from the date of determination.

7. Billing and Collections

7.1 Amounts generally billed (AGB). The Hospital calculates amounts generally billed using the look-back method based on Medicare fee-for-service claims. The current AGB percentage is 33% of gross charges.

7.2 Presumptive eligibility. The Hospital does not make presumptive eligibility determinations; an application is required.

7.4 Refunds. Amounts paid in excess of the approved patient balance will be refunded.

7.5 Collections. The Hospital will not engage in extraordinary collection actions before making reasonable efforts to determine whether a patient is eligible for financial assistance. The Billing and Collections Policy is available free of charge.

Questions: call (936) 555-0400 or write to Business Office, 1500 Example Timberland Drive, Lufkin, TX 75904.